

McLink Group Recruitment Portal

User Requirements Study and Approval

Document status: For CEO review and approval **Version:** 1.1
Date: 27 August 2026 **Prepared for:** McLink Group **Prepared by:** Recruitment Portal Project Team

1. Purpose

This document defines the business, user, functional, security, and operational requirements for the McLink Group Recruitment Portal. It is intended to create a shared baseline for implementation, testing, deployment, and future change requests.

CEO approval confirms that the requirements and priorities below represent the intended recruitment operating model for the current release.

2. Business objectives

The portal shall:

- 1. Standardize recruitment activity from role request through interview stages.
 - 2. Reduce manual handling of job descriptions, resumes, candidate records, and interview scheduling.
- 1. Give HR and management timely visibility of recruitment status and actions.
 - 2. Protect candidate and company information through authenticated access, role-based permissions, secure links, and server-side validation.
- 1. Use AI to assist with resume screening and voice interviews while keeping recruitment decisions under authorized human control.
- 1. Provide a traceable record of important recruitment decisions, messages, bookings, and status changes.

3. Stakeholders and users

User	Primary responsibilities	Required access
HR / Recruiter	Create roles, complete recruitment setup, review candidates, manage interviews	Create, review, and operate recruitment workflows
Hiring manager / HOD	Provide role information and participate in review or interviews	Access according to assigned permissions
Administrator	Manage users, settings, integrations, and access	Full administrative access
Candidate	Apply, receive interview instructions, book an authorized slot, and attend interviews	Tokenized candidate links only

Access shall be granted through the maintained user directory and shall not be based solely on a matching email domain.

4. Scope

In scope

- Authenticated internal recruitment dashboard.
- Role creation, status management, approvals, and recruitment setup.
- Structured job description, screening criteria, and interview-question data.
- Candidate application and resume intake.
- Bulk resume processing and AI-assisted screening.
- AI voice-interview booking, scheduled calling, results, and HR review.
- Human final-interview scheduling and shared calendar integration.
- Candidate email notifications and booking confirmations.
- Google Sheets and n8n workflow integration.
- User permissions, operational safeguards, and documentation.

Out of scope for this release

- Automatic hiring or rejection decisions without human approval.
- Payroll, onboarding, employee-record, or performance-management functions.
- Public access to internal recruitment screens or internal data.
- A general-purpose external job board.
- Replacement of the company's authoritative HR or finance systems.

5. End-to-end user requirements

UR-01: Secure access

The system shall require authenticated, authorized access for internal users. Unauthenticated visitors shall not be able to open internal dashboards, APIs, candidate records, or administrative functions. Candidate-facing actions shall require a valid, purpose-specific invitation or booking token.

UR-02: Role request and approval

Authorized users shall be able to submit a staff addition or replacement role request. The system shall assign a unique role identifier, validate required fields, record the creator, and support discussion, return, hold, approval, and rejection status changes.

UR-03: Recruitment setup

Authorized HR users shall be able to maintain the job description, screening criteria, salary and experience requirements, license requirements, and initial interview questions. The system shall prevent publication until the required setup fields and applicable interview choices are complete.

All mandatory recruitment-setup fields, screening criteria, interview questions, prompts, and evaluation instructions shall be reviewed and validated for discriminatory, exclusionary, or otherwise unlawful language before they can be published or used by an AI workflow. The system shall identify and block criteria based on protected or irrelevant personal characteristics, including age, gender, race, ethnicity, nationality, religion,

disability, medical history, family status, appearance, accent, location, or economic background, unless a lawful, documented, job-related exception has been approved through the required legal or compliance process.

UR-04: Candidate and resume intake

The system shall accept candidate details and resume files through a controlled candidate experience. It shall validate file type and required details, create an application identity, and prevent duplicate processing of the same completed resume for the same role.

UR-05: AI-assisted screening

The system shall submit eligible resumes to the configured screening workflow, store structured screening results, and show HR the evidence used for review. AI screening shall be treated as decision support and shall not make a final hiring decision on behalf of McLink Group.

AI screening prompts, criteria, mandatory fields, scoring rubrics, and output fields shall not contain language or rules that directly or indirectly discriminate against candidates. Screening shall use only consistent, job-related evidence and shall not request, infer, score, or rely on protected characteristics or proxies for protected characteristics. The system shall reject or flag discriminatory instructions before an AI screening workflow is executed, and HR shall be able to review the criteria and evidence supporting each result.

UR-06: AI voice-interview invitation and booking

When a candidate is approved for an AI voice interview, the system shall send a secure booking invitation containing an expiring booking link. Candidates shall see only valid available slots and shall receive a confirmation after a booking is successfully reserved.

The invitation and confirmation emails shall contain this exact notice:

AI Interview Notice: This interview will be conducted with the assistance of an AI interviewing system, which may record, transcribe and assess your responses against job-related criteria. Any information or responses generated, transcribed, summarized, or communicated by the AI may be inaccurate, incomplete, misleading, or inconsistent with the candidate's actual statements or qualifications. AI output is not verified and must not be relied upon as an official statement, representation, commitment, promise, or offer by McLink Group. The candidate remains responsible for the accuracy of information submitted or communicated and must not misrepresent their identity, qualifications, experience, or responses. McLink Group does not accept responsibility for decisions or actions based on unverified AI output, and only an authorized McLink Group representative may make or confirm an official employment-related statement or offer in writing.

The same disclaimer shall be communicated clearly at the start of every AI phone interview and, where technically supported, repeated before the call ends. The disclaimer shall explain that AI-generated questions, transcripts, summaries, and assessments may contain errors or hallucinations, and that they do not create any representation, commitment, promise, or offer on behalf of McLink Group.

UR-07: Interview scheduling and capacity

The system shall validate slot availability at the time of booking, prevent expired or reused tokens, apply the configured capacity rules, record the candidate's timezone and contact number, and create the corresponding call queue record.

UR-08: Voice interview execution and review

The configured AI voice service shall receive only the information required to conduct the interview. The system shall record the provider status, transcript, structured result, and processing errors where available. HR shall be able to review the interview evidence and record an authorized human decision.

AI phone interviews shall use only approved, job-related questions and evaluation criteria and shall not solicit or infer discriminatory information. The system shall preserve the disclaimer presented to the candidate and shall clearly identify AI-generated questions, transcripts, summaries, and results as unverified decision-support content. No AI phone-interview output shall be treated as an official statement or employment commitment by McLink Group, and all consequential decisions shall remain subject to authorized human review.

UR-09: Human final interview

Where the candidate proceeds to a final interview, the system shall provide a secure booking link, validate the selected slot, and synchronize the booking with the approved shared Google Calendar. Human interview invitations shall be clearly distinguished from AI voice-interview communications.

UR-10: Notifications

The system shall send relevant candidate and internal notifications for booking, confirmation, workflow errors, and configured recruitment status events. Failed notifications shall be visible to authorized HR users and retryable where safe.

UR-11: Auditability and data integrity

The system shall preserve application and role identifiers, timestamps, status history, processing state, booking state, and the identity of authorized users performing material actions. Partial failures shall not silently appear as successful recruitment actions.

6. Non-functional requirements

Security and privacy

- Production traffic shall use HTTPS.
- Session cookies, webhook secrets, API credentials, and provider tokens shall

remain server-side and shall not be exposed in browser code or source control.

- Every protected page and API shall enforce authorization on the server.
- Access shall follow least privilege and be reviewed when a user changes role

or leaves the organization.

- Candidate links and booking tokens shall be unguessable, purpose-specific,

time-limited, and single-use where applicable.

- Resume files, transcripts, and candidate data shall be accessible only to

authorized users and approved service integrations.

- Logs and error messages shall avoid unnecessary personal or credential data.

Usability

- The portal shall be usable on current desktop and mobile browsers.

- Forms shall identify required fields and provide understandable validation

messages.

- Destructive or irreversible actions shall require clear confirmation.
- Candidate emails shall display correctly on common email clients and provide

clear next steps.

Reliability and operations

- Integrations shall use explicit contracts, validation, retry rules, and

recoverable error states.

- The system shall provide operational documentation for deployment, testing,

migration, troubleshooting, and access administration.

- Changes shall be tested before production release and the production version

shall be identifiable.

7. Integrations and authoritative data

The current operating model uses:

- Next.js for the portal interface and server-side API routes.
- Google login and the maintained user directory for internal access.
- Google Sheets for configured recruitment records and workflow state.
- n8n for recruitment automation, notifications, and external workflow steps.
- An approved AI voice provider for scheduled calls and interview results.
- Google Calendar for human final-interview scheduling.

Each integration shall have a documented owner, credential owner, failure mode, and recovery procedure. Server-generated identifiers and state transitions shall remain authoritative over values supplied by the browser or automation client.

8. Acceptance criteria

The release shall be considered acceptable when:

1. An unauthorized user cannot access internal pages, APIs, candidate records,

or settings.

1. An authorized HR user can create, configure, submit, review, and progress a

role through the approved workflow.

1. A candidate can complete an authorized application and, where approved,

book a valid AI voice-interview slot exactly once.

1. Booking invitation and confirmation emails contain the approved AI notice

without paraphrasing or omission, and the AI phone interview communicates the approved disclaimer at the required points.

1. Expired, invalid, reused, over-capacity, or unauthorized booking requests are rejected safely.

1. HR can review screening and voice-interview evidence before recording a human decision.

1. Mandatory recruitment fields, screening criteria, prompts, interview questions, and evaluation fields are blocked or flagged when they contain discriminatory or irrelevant criteria.

1. Human final-interview bookings are validated and reflected in the shared calendar where configured.

1. Integration failures are visible, do not falsely report success, and can be recovered using the documented process.

1. Security, contract, workflow, and browser smoke tests pass for the release.

9. Implementation roadmap and release plan

The following phase-by-phase timeline is the delivery plan associated with this requirements baseline. Dates are target dates and may be adjusted through the change-control process. A phase is complete only when its stated exit criteria are met and no unresolved critical regression prevents progression.

Phase 1 — Critical QC fixes and core workflow

Target: 26–28 August 2026

Objective: Close the major functional blockers so the core recruitment flow is stable.

Date	Task	Owner	Deliverable
26 Aug	Fix post-screening notifications	Julio	HR and candidate notifications trigger automatically after screening
26 Aug	Add F2F interview venue/address	Julio	Interview email includes physical address, room, and arrival details
26–27 Aug	Fix Ella interview summary misattribution	Julio	Candidate answers map to the proper interview question
26–27 Aug	Remove Management approval	Julio	Simplified workflow without a Management approval dependency
27–28 Aug	Implement credit-based pricing	Julio	Credit wallet, deductions, balance checking, and discount logic
27–28 Aug	Implement candidate no-show lifecycle	Julio	Attempt 1–3 retry flow and final handling
28 Aug	Quick regression test	Julio + QA	Core features retested after changes

Phase exit criteria: Post-screening alerts work; F2F invitations contain complete venue information; Ella summary mapping is resolved; Management approval is removed without breaking the workflow; the credit-system MVP and no-show/three-attempt lifecycle are functional; and no new P0 regression issues exist. The first four items directly address the functional and AI workflow blockers identified by QC.

Phase 2 — Backend and performance improvement

Target: 27–31 August 2026

Objective: Reduce system latency and prepare the backend for new integrations.

Date	Task	Owner	Deliverable
27–28 Aug	Review Google Sheets dependencies	July	Identify critical tables/processes to migrate
28–30 Aug	Create target database structure	July	Database schema for users, jobs, candidates, screening, and interview data
29–31 Aug	Migrate critical backend processes	July	Critical read/write processes moved away from Google Sheets
29–31 Aug	Optimize n8n execution	July + Julio	Long-running workflows reduced or moved to asynchronous processing
31 Aug	Performance verification	July + Julio	Compare response time against the current workflow

Phase exit criteria: Critical backend operations no longer depend fully on Google Sheets; n8n workflows do not unnecessarily block the frontend; screening, parsing, and notification latency is improved; and existing records remain intact. The QC report identifies synchronous n8n execution as a performance and reliability failure.

Phase 3 — Cloud resume-upload integration

Target: 29 August–2 September 2026

Objective: Allow large resume batches to enter Ella without relying only on manual local uploads.

Google Drive — 29 August–1 September

- Configure Google Drive access and authentication.
- Add file selection and multiple-resume selection.
- Import selected files into Ella and push them into the existing screening queue.
- Preserve filename and source metadata.
- Add duplicate detection, batch progress, and failure handling.

OneDrive — 31 August–2 September

- Configure Microsoft/OneDrive authentication.
- Add multi-file selection and connect selected files to the same screening pipeline.
- Add permission handling, failure handling, duplicate protection, and batch status.

Owner: Julio + July

Phase exit criteria: Both Drive and OneDrive can import multiple resumes; imported files enter the same screening process as normal uploads; duplicate screening jobs are prevented; and failed files can be identified without stopping the whole batch.

Phase 4 — Documentation and AI support

Target: 29 August–2 September 2026

Objective: Produce client documentation and use it as the knowledge base for an in-system support assistant.

User manual — Owner: Julio — 29 August–2 September

The manual shall cover the system overview, HOD workflow, HR workflow, candidate flow, CV screening, AI phone interview, interview scheduling, credit system, bulk upload, and troubleshooting.

AI support bot — Owner: Julio — 1–2 September

Build the support assistant, connect it to the approved documentation, enable operational questions, provide step-by-step instructions, and add a fallback when information is unavailable.

Knowledge base — Owner: Julio — 2 September

Upload the finalized user manual, index the documentation, test document retrieval, and validate answers against the actual guide.

Phase exit criteria: A client-ready manual exists; the support bot retrieves answers from the manual; and bot answers are grounded in approved system documentation.

Phase 5 — Hosting and batch-capacity validation

Target: 1–2 September 2026

Owner: Julio

Objective: Determine whether direct GoDaddy uploads support large batches and define a safe upload limit.

The validation shall review the GoDaddy upload configuration, individual file and request-size limits, timeout and memory limits, progressively larger batch tests, processing time, and the failure threshold. It shall compare direct uploads with Drive and OneDrive uploads and document the recommended maximum direct batch size.

Phase 6 — Ella AI-scoring validation

Target: 2–3 September 2026

Owner: Julio + HR/QA

Objective: Validate Ella's AI evaluation against the actual HR scoring standard.

Representative candidate examples shall be manually scored by HR and run through Ella. The results shall be compared, material scoring differences identified, scoring prompts or logic tuned where necessary, and the benchmark rerun and documented.

Phase exit criteria: Ella scoring has been formally compared with HR's rubric; material discrepancies are corrected or documented; and QA/HR accepts the results for UAT. This closes the scoring-benchmark item pending in the QC report.

Phase 7 — Full regression testing

Target: 3 September 2026

Owner: Development + QA

The complete system shall be tested across login/SSO, RBAC, job and role creation, the simplified approval flow, resume upload, Google Drive and OneDrive import, single and bulk screening, post-screening notifications, credit deductions and insufficient-credit handling, interview booking, F2F invitation, AI phone interview, missed-call handling, the three-attempt lifecycle, transcript generation, Ella summary, AI scoring, database operations, n8n performance, form persistence, and error handling.

Exit criterion: No unresolved critical regression defects.

Phase 8 — Formal QC retest

Target: 4 September 2026

Owner: QA + Development

QC shall specifically retest the six original open items:

- Post-screening notifications.
- F2F interview address.
- Ella summary misattribution.
- Applicant no-show handling.
- n8n/system latency.
- Ella scoring accuracy.

The QC report currently blocks Code Freeze until remaining material issues are corrected and retested.

Exit criterion: Original blockers are cleared or formally accepted.

Phase 9 — Critical fix window and Code Freeze

Target: 5 September 2026

Owner: Julio + July + QA

Only critical issues found during the QC retest shall be fixed. The affected test cases shall be rerun, no P0/P1 blockers shall remain open, and the final release candidate shall be tagged.

Code Freeze — 5 September: After this point there shall be no new features or workflow redesign; only critical defect fixes are permitted.

Phase 10 — Formal UAT

Target: 6–7 September 2026

Owner: HR + QA + Development

UAT shall cover the following user and system scenarios:

- **HOD:** Create a role/job, submit requirements, and follow the simplified workflow.
- **HR:** Review roles and applications, perform screening, review Ella scoring, and arrange interviews.
- **Candidate:** Application, screening, notification, booking, AI interview, and missed-call/retry scenarios.
- **System:** Credit usage, notifications, upload integrations, support bot, and database performance.

Exit criterion: Formal UAT sign-off.

Phase 11 — Production readiness

Target: 8 September 2026

Owner: Development team

Before production deployment, the team shall confirm that UAT issues are closed; production configuration, database, and n8n workflows are verified; credit rules and notification credentials are verified; Drive and OneDrive integration is verified; backup and rollback procedures are confirmed; and documentation is finalized.

Final milestone summary

Milestone	Target
Core QC, workflow, and credits complete	28 Aug 2026
Backend/performance improvement complete	31 Aug 2026
Cloud upload, documentation, and support bot complete	2 Sep 2026
AI validation and full regression	3 Sep 2026
QC retest	4 Sep 2026
Code Freeze	5 Sep 2026
Formal UAT	6–7 Sep 2026
Production ready	8 Sep 2026

The development sequence is: **Fix Core** → **Stabilize Backend** → **Add Integrations** → **Validate AI** → **Regression** → **QC** → **Freeze** → **UAT** → **Production**.

10. Assumptions and decisions requiring confirmation

- McLink Group will nominate an owner for the portal, Google Workspace access, Google Sheets, n8n, AI voice provider, and shared calendar.
- HR will define the retention period and deletion process for resumes, transcripts, and candidate records.
- HR and management will confirm the final access role assignments before broad internal rollout.
- Any change to automated screening, interview questions, candidate messaging, or AI data handling will be reviewed and approved before release.
- Legal or privacy review will be obtained where required by the jurisdictions in which candidates are recruited.

11. Approval and sign-off

By signing below, the CEO confirms that this User Requirements Study is an approved baseline for the McLink Group Recruitment Portal. Changes to these requirements after approval shall be recorded, assessed for impact, and approved through the company’s change-control process.

CEO name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Comments or conditions of approval:
